



**MR. CLEAN** Vneet S. Jaain, MD, Adani Green Energy

Jaain has led many first-of-its-kind projects in the country, driven by his deep technical understanding and sector focus. The Adani Group has completed a number of significant energy projects under his leadership, including the biggest solar plant in the world at a single site, at Kamuthi, in Tamil Nadu. The facility covers 2,500 acres, or about 950 Olympic-sized football fields. The 650-MW facility was completed in a record eight months, with 8,500 people toiling day and night. “It gave us a big boost and confidence in the group. We can execute large-scale projects while managing all the contingencies and challenges,” says Jaain. The Kamuthi plant was completed in 2016.

In 2022, AGEL commissioned a 390-MW wind-solar

hybrid power plant in Rajasthan, the first such plant in India. In March 2023, AGEL’s fourth wind-solar hybrid power plant with a capacity of 700 MW became fully operational in Rajasthan’s Jaisalmer. With this, AGEL’s operating wind-solar hybrid portfolio reached 2,140 MW, the largest wind-solar hybrid cluster in the world.

“At present, we have the most ambitious renewable projects, not only for Adani Group but also for India and the world,” says Jaain, a mechanical engineer by training.

The company also has plans to develop 30 GW of renewable energy capacity at Khavda in Gujarat, which will be operational over the next five years. Khavda, located in the Kutch district of Gujarat, is a promising location for wind and solar energy projects. When completed, the Khavda renewable energy park will be the largest such installation in the world. “We have already operationalised 551 MW of solar capacity in Khavda by supplying power to the national grid,” adds Jaain.

While initially appointed as MD & CEO in July 2020 for a period of five years, Jaain relinquished the CEO’s role at AGEL in May 2023, with Amit Singh stepping in as the new CEO. Under the leadership of these two, AGEL is aiming to deliver 45 GW of power by 2030. The company is focussed on delivering affordable power. “We have developed the in-house capabilities to execute large-scale projects, which brings economies of scale,” says Jaain.

The company is also supporting the indigenous supply chain for equipment used in renewable energy (RE). AGEL is leveraging group synergy in RE equipment manufacturing to accelerate the clean energy transition. For example, Adani Wind, the wind manufacturing division of Adani New Industries Limited (ANIL), has an integrated manufacturing ecosystem for wind turbine generators (WTG) with a manufacturing capacity of 1.5 GW, which produces India’s largest on-shore WTG of 5.2 MW. Adani Wind is focussed on de-

| 117

## Rising Again

► The Adani Green Energy stock outperformed the broader market index in the past three years

► The stock enjoys a higher multiple because of the new sector and huge capacity expansion plans

Data has been indexed to 100

Source ACE Equity

